Nigel Farage:

The BREXIT Story



UKIP

As a founding member of the UK Independence party in 1993, Farage is a staunch Eurosceptic, believing EU integration is bad for an independent nation. He became an MEP in 1999 from where he campaigned with UKIP to keep the UK separate from the EU as much as possible

Brexit

Following the 2015 European migrant crisis, UKIP renewed loud calls for an independence referendum, for which the conservative prime minister at the time David Cameron, a populist in his own right, agreed to hold. Farage kept ferociously campaigning with speeches and media appearances to increase the **leave** vote. Increasingly using Muslim extremism and its apparent threats to the UK through immigration (Cap 2019). He was able to successfully garner a 52% result to leave the EU in the 2016 referendum, from where he would further campaign to implement BREXIT until 2020.



Reform UK

Following a series of controversies and scandals from the UKIP, Farage left that party to form the BREXIT party to further continue his mission formalize Brexit policy, he would rename it to Reform UK in 2021. After EU-UK trade agreements were completed in 2020, Farage's mission was seemingly complete, along with the pandemic, Farage took an informal break from politics. This break was short lived however as with the renewed Reform UK party Farage reentered UK domestic politics in 2024 winning a seat in the house of parliament where reform UK gained only 5 seats. In part due to inadequacies of Conservative and Labour governments, Reform UK became one of the highest polling party in the UK, running at 31% as of September 2025 (The Economist).

Populist Overview

Farage's populist portfolio consists of a form of British superiority against EU bureaucrats enforcing "invading" migrants and rules upon the UK economy which he sees as above EU rule of law. This nationalist twist is further aided by Farage's modern actions, establishing his own party: Reform UK, to reenter UK politics. Although this new party holds many of the broad views the conservatives and the previous UKIP held; of this party he is the sole figurehead, which demonstrates his populist pull within this modern right wing anti-immigration movement.

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